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23.10.2026 19:39:31 GMT+0200
Dokument podpisany elektronicznie
podpisem zaufanym

The Fallacy of Infinity: From Roman Matrix Bloat to the [-9, +9] Decimal Balance Scale in Critical Infrastructure

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Date: October 2026

Abstract

Modern artificial intelligence is trapped in a computational trap of its own making: attempting to solve physical control problems by scaling multi-dimensional matrices and continuous floating-point parameters—a methodology structurally equivalent to the additive inefficiency of Roman numerals. In safety-critical operational technology (OT) and L0 infrastructure, infinity is not a feature; it is a systemic vulnerability. This paper unifies three foundational concepts: the elimination of stochastic drift via a bounded random walk, the simplicity of the mechanical balance scale, and the absolute precision of a discrete decimal state space constrained between -9 and +9. By replacing continuous probability with bounded positional quantization, we establish a deterministic, ultra-low-latency architecture for high-risk physical environments.

1. The Roman Numeral Fallacy: Why Matrix Bloat Fails in OT

If we examine historical computational evolution, the Roman numeral system (I, V, X, L, C, D, M) lacked zero and positionality. To express a larger or more complex value, Romans had to continuously append new symbols, creating heavy, rigid, and uncalculatable strings.

Contemporary AI mirrors this exact architectural flaw. By scaling parameter spaces into billions of weights and continuous floating-point vectors, developers are effectively building digital structures out of Roman numerals. In closed IT environments, this inefficiency results in semantic hallucinations. In L0 physical infrastructure—such as managing pressure differentials and thermal profiles in Direct-to-Chip cooling (mCDU)—this heavy, stochastic brute-force introduces fatal latency and unpredictable behavior.

2. The Illusion of Infinity in Control Systems

A fundamental axiom of modern software engineering is that *more is better*—more parameters, higher resolution, and continuous mathematical spaces approaching infinity. In physical control theory, **infinity is a mathematical and engineering error.**

Leaving a system to navigate an infinite or unconstrained continuous space (-\infty to +\infty) guarantees that cumulative micro-deviations will result in a destructive random walk. True safety-critical systems do not compute absolute infinities; they measure finite, discrete boundaries. An actuator, a valve, or a power grid does not have infinite states of being—it has functional zones ranging from safe operation to catastrophic structural failure.

3. The Balance Scale and the [-9, +9] Decimal Axis

To escape the trap of continuous probabilistic drift, we must return to foundational, positional logic—similar to the revolutionary simplicity of Arabic numerals, zero, and the mechanical balance scale.

We propose a closed, discrete state space bounded strictly between **-9 and +9**, yielding exactly **19 unique, unalterable operational states**:

- **0 (The Neutral Reference):** The zero-point of thermodynamic and structural equilibrium (the fulcrum of the balance scale).
- **\pm 1 to \pm 8 (Granular Quantization Steps):** Finite, discrete steps of corrective control. Instead of vague probabilities, the system executes precise, step-wise operational adjustments.
- **\pm 9 (The Absorbing Boundary):** The hard invariant limit. If a random walk pushes the system toward \pm 9, formal verification (such as a Z3-Solver) interdicts execution instantaneously, preventing physical rupture.

4. Conclusion

Securing critical infrastructure does not require infinite computational power or massive neural networks. By recognizing that infinity and unconstrained floating-point spaces are architectural liabilities, we can reduce control logic to a finite, elegant scale. Anchored by a zero-point, framed by a balance scale, and mapped across a strict [-9, +9] decimal axis, we bridge the gap between abstract logic and absolute physical safety.